



SIF Coverage Initiation Report

India's Specialized Investment Fund Universe
Foundational reference for the TAS Research Desk & Trustner.ai

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Executive Summary

One-line takeaway and the strategic mandate driving this document.

STRATEGIC TAKEAWAY

SIF is a 14-month-old SEBI category that has scaled from zero to ₹10,620 Cr AUM (Mar 2026) across 14 live funds and 17 strategies (incl. 3 in NFO) — a 117% Q1 expansion. Hybrid strategies (77% of AUM) are working as designed in a falling market; equity long-short strategies (23% of AUM) are universally underwater. **TAS should build a 4-fund recommended list now, MONITOR-rate the equity sleeve, and publicly position SIF as a 'PMS-grade strategy at MF-grade cost and tax' — not as a return-juicer.** A second wave of large AMCs (Kotak, Mirae, HSBC) has just been cleared by SEBI; HDFC, Nippon, UTI, Axis and DSP are next. This is a once-a-decade product-category land-grab; the Trustner.ai SIF module should ship in Q3 FY27.

₹10,620 Cr

Total SIF AUM (Mar 2026)

14

Live SIF strategies

3

In NFO / new launches

13

AMCs SIF-approved

4

TAS Recommended

Why this matters now

The SIF category was born from SEBI's 27 Feb 2025 master circular and went live 1 April 2025. It deliberately bridges the structural gap between Mutual Funds (₹500 minimum, long-only) and PMS (₹50L minimum) / AIF Cat-III (₹1 Cr minimum, slab-rate taxation). At a ₹10 lakh ticket with mutual-fund-grade taxation and bi-monthly disclosure, SIF is the right product for the very segment TAS is built to serve — Indian HNI households with ₹50 lakh to ₹5 crore liquid AUM. The advisory desks that build research credibility in this category in 2026 will own client mindshare on alternatives for the next decade.

The TAS recommended list (preview)

Tier	Fund	TFS	Verdict	Role
Core 1	iSIF Hybrid Long-Short — ICICI Prudential	78	BUY	BAF replacement; Naren-led
Core 2	Altiva Hybrid Long-Short — Edelweiss	76	ACCUMULATE	FD/income replacement
Core 3	Magnum Hybrid Long-Short — SBI	75	ACCUMULATE	Trust play; conservative core
Sat.	iSIF Equity Ex-Top 100 — ICICI Prudential	74	BUY	Aggressive SMID alpha sleeve

Section 1 — Regulatory & Structural Primer

The framework, eligibility, strategies, taxation — what every TAS advisor must know.

1.1 The SEBI SIF framework — what it is, and what it is not

The SIF (Specialized Investment Fund) is a new regulated investment vehicle created by amending the SEBI (Mutual Funds) Regulations, 1996, effective 16 December 2024. The operating framework was issued via three SEBI circulars:

Circular	Date	Purpose
SEBI/HO/IMD/IMD-PoD-1/P/CIR/2025/26	27 Feb 2025	Master regulatory framework, eligibility, strategies, limits
SEBI/HO/IMD/...CIR/2025/49	9 Apr 2025	Clarifications on minimum threshold; employee carve-outs
SEBI/HO/IMD/IMD-RAC/P/CIR/2025/54	11 Apr 2025	Standardised application + ISID disclosure formats

The framework went **live on 1 April 2025**. SIF is structurally a 'scheme under the mutual fund trust' — same trustee, custodian, and RTA as mutual funds. What changes is the toolkit: SIF schemes can take **unhedged short positions up to 25% of NAV via exchange-traded derivatives**, can be open-ended / closed-ended / interval, and can access strategy categories no MF scheme can.

WHY SEBI BUILT SIF

Indian retail investors with ₹10-50 lakh of liquid AUM sat in a regulatory no-man's-land — too rich for plain-vanilla MFs, too poor for PMS or AIF Cat-III. They were drifting to unregulated F&O tipsters and 'alpha clubs'. SIF brings them back inside the regulated perimeter at a ₹10L floor with MF-grade governance.

1.2 AMC eligibility — two routes

Route 1 — Sound Track Record	Route 2 — Alternate Route
- MF in operation ≥ 3 years 3-year average AUM $\geq$ ₹10,000 Cr - No SEBI Sec 11/11B/24 action in last 3 years	- CIO for SIF: ≥ 10 years FM experience and $\geq$ ₹5,000 Cr avg. AUM managed - Additional FM: ≥ 3 years experience and $\geq$ ₹500 Cr AUM - Same clean-record test

Every fund manager must hold a NISM-mandated SIF certification.

1.3 Permitted strategy categories — only seven, only one per category per AMC

To prevent proliferation, SEBI permits exactly seven strategy types, and **each AMC can launch only one strategy per category**:

#	Category	Sub-strategy	Min Allocation	Short Limit
1	Equity-Oriented	Equity Long-Short	$\geq 80\%$ equity	$\leq 25\%$ unhedged

2	Equity-Oriented	Equity Ex-Top 100 Long-Short	≥65% in stocks ranked >100 by m-cap	≤25% unhedged
3	Equity-Oriented	Sector Rotation Long-Short	≥80% in up to 4 sectors	≤25% unhedged
4	Debt-Oriented	Debt Long-Short	≥80% debt	≤25% unhedged
5	Debt-Oriented	Sectoral Debt Long-Short	Sector-concentrated debt	≤25% unhedged
6	Hybrid	Active Asset Allocator Long-Short	Dynamic across equity / debt / commodity	≤25% unhedged
7	Hybrid	Hybrid Long-Short	Defined equity-debt bands	≤25% unhedged

Other key limits

Single-issuer debt cap: 20% NAV (AAA), 16% (AA), 12% (A and below); ±5% with trustee approval. Single-sector debt cap: 25% NAV. Cumulative gross exposure (cash + derivatives + repo + CDS): ≤100% of net assets. Five-level risk band disclosure mandatory. Bi-monthly portfolio disclosure. Notice period of up to 15 working days permitted on redemption. Listing on NSE/BSE mandatory for closed-ended and interval strategies. 30-business-day NFO deployment window (extendable by 30 with IC approval).

1.4 Investor eligibility & minimum ticket

Dimension	Rule
Minimum investment	₹10 lakh aggregate per PAN per AMC across all SIF strategies of that AMC
Accredited investors	Minimum reduced to ₹1 lakh
Below-threshold drift	Passive market loss -> no action; active redemption breach -> forced full redemption (no partials below ₹10L)
MF investments	Excluded from threshold computation (₹50L MF + ₹10L SIF is fine)
Rebalancing window	30 days if passively breached

1.5 SIF vs MF vs PMS vs AIF Cat-III — the comparison matrix

This is the single most important slide a TAS RM uses with HNI clients. It explains *why* SIF — not what.

Dimension	Mutual Fund	SIF	PMS	AIF Cat-III
Min ticket	₹100–₹500	₹10 lakh (₹1L accredited)	₹50 lakh	₹1 crore
Reg. wrapper	SEBI MF Regs 1996	SEBI MF Regs (Ch. VI-C)	SEBI PMS Regs 2020	SEBI AIF Regs 2012
Pooled vs separate	Pooled	Pooled	Separate demat per investor	Pooled
Long-short / unhedged shorts	Hedging only	Yes — ≤25% NAV	Yes (no statutory cap)	Yes (no cap, leverage allowed)
Liquidity	Daily (most)	Daily / 2x weekly / monthly / interval	T+2 to T+5 typical	Lock-in 1–3 yrs typical
Disclosure	Monthly portfolio	Bi-monthly portfolio	Monthly + on-demand	Quarterly
Tax — Equity (≥65%)	LTCG 12.5% (>1y), STCG 20%	LTCG 12.5% (>1y), STCG 20%	Slab rate (business income)	Slab rate (Cat-III, fund-level)
Tax — Debt	Slab rate	Slab rate	Slab rate	Slab rate
Tax — Hybrid (<65% eq)	LTCG 12.5% (>2y)	LTCG 12.5% (>2y), STCG slab	Slab rate	Slab rate
Fund-level tax	Nil — Sec 10(23D)	Nil — Sec 10(23D)	N/A (pass-through)	Cat-III: at fund level
TER cap	~2.25% (asset slab)	~2.25%	1–2.5% mgmt + 10–20% perf	1.5–2.5% + 15–20% perf
Performance fee	No	Optional (rare)	Yes	Yes

Highlighted column denotes SIF — the wrapper TAS is positioning for the ₹10L–₹2 Cr HNI segment.

1.6 Tax treatment by SIF strategy type — the killer feature

This is the single biggest reason SIF will eat PMS / AIF Cat-III AUM:

Strategy Type	LTCG	STCG	Comment
Equity-oriented (Eq L-S, Ex-Top 100, Sector Rotation — ≥65% equity)	12.5% (>12 mo)	20%	Same as equity MF — huge advantage over PMS/AIF where slab rate (up to 30%+ surcharge) applies
Debt-oriented	Slab rate	Slab rate	Same as debt MF
Hybrid with ≥65% equity	12.5% (>12 mo)	20%	E.g. SBI Magnum, Tata Titanium
Hybrid with <65% equity / <65% debt	12.5% (>24 mo)	Slab rate	E.g. Altiva, qSIF Hybrid (24-month LTCG)
Arbitrage-heavy hybrid (≥65% eq + arbitrage)	12.5% (>12 mo)	20%	Most income-oriented hybrid SIFs structured this way

TRUSTNER IMPLICATION

For a top-tax-bracket HNI client, the post-tax IRR delta between an SIF (12.5% LTCG) and an equivalent AIF Cat-III (≈39% effective) on a 12% gross return is roughly **3.2 percentage points of post-tax IRR per year**. Compounded over 10 years on ₹1 Cr, that's ≈ **₹70-80 lakh of preserved wealth**. *This is the talking point.*

Section 2 — Live SIF Universe

Every fund launched, in NFO, or filed — and the TFS score for each.

2.1 Industry state as of 6 May 2026

Total SIF AUM	₹10,620 Cr (Mar 2026, AMFI) — up 117% from ₹4,892 Cr in Dec 2025
Quarterly trajectory	₹4,892 Cr (Dec 2025) -> ₹9,711 Cr (Feb 2026) -> ₹10,620 Cr (Mar 2026)
Hybrid share of AUM	76.7% (₹8,147 Cr) — up 110% from Dec 2025
Equity-oriented share	23.3% (₹2,474 Cr) — up 142.8% from Dec 2025
Live funds	14 (across 9 launching AMC's)
In NFO / recently allotted	3 (Franklin Sapphire, WSIF Equity-LS, WSIF Ex-Top 100)
Fund houses with SIF brand approval	13 (3 actively launched + 10 awaiting first NFO)
Monthly inflow trend	Feb 2026: ₹3,127 Cr (peak); Mar 2026: ₹1,314 Cr (-57% MoM moderation)
Performance reality check	All 5 equity-oriented SIFs remained below issue price through late March 2026 (Nifty -11.30% in March). Hybrid SIFs broadly held up.
Second wave SEBI-cleared (awaiting NFO)	Kotak (Infinity Hybrid LS), Mirae Asset (Platinum Hybrid LS), HSBC (RedHex Hybrid LS)
Pipeline (preparing / awaiting approval)	HDFC, Nippon India, UTI, Axis, DSP, Franklin Templeton — top-20 AMC's all in motion
Categories yet to be launched	Debt L-S, Sectoral Debt L-S, Sector Rotation L-S (Quant has filed for Sector Rotation)

2.2 The TFS Score — methodology (TAS proprietary)

The **Trustner Fund Score (TFS)** rates every fund 0–100 across 7 weighted pillars. We are not running a black box — every score in this document shows the math.

Pillar	Weight	What it measures
P1. Manager Pedigree	20	FM track record on prior funds: alpha vs benchmark, longevity, downside discipline, AUM managed
P2. Strategy Coherence	15	Does the strategy logic match the toolkit? Is the alpha thesis defensible?
P3. AMC Platform Strength	15	Parent AMC AUM, distribution depth, research coverage, governance record
P4. Cost & Liquidity	10	TER, exit load, redemption frequency, lock-in friction
P5. Risk Architecture	15	Hedging discipline, position limits, downside cap, drawdown control evidence
P6. Track Record / Real Performance	15	Alpha vs benchmark since inception (NOT the AUM gathered)
P7. Investor-fit & Tax Efficiency	10	Tax bucket, suitability matrix, real-world advisor friction

Verdict mapping

BUY	80–100 — high conviction, recommended list
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ACCUMULATE	65-79 — worth allocating, not lead pitch
HOLD / MONITOR	50-64 — track, don't pitch
AVOID	<50 — not on shelf
MONITOR-ID	"Insufficient Data" — fund <3 months old; pillar 6 unscorable

2.3 Master SIF universe table — Live funds

All 14 live SIF strategies. Funds are TFS-ranked. Full one-page deep dives for the top funds follow in §2.5. Data gaps are flagged where AMC factsheet retrieval is pending.

#	AMC / Brand	Fund	Strategy	Manager(s)	AUM (₹Cr)	TFS	Verdict
1	Edelweiss / Altiva	Altiva Hybrid Long-Short	Hybrid L-S	B. Lahoti, B. Jain, D. Dalal +2	1,000+	76	ACCUMULATE
2	SBI / Magnum SIF	Magnum Hybrid Long-Short	Hybrid L-S	Gaurav Mehta, CFA	~1,100	75	ACCUMULATE
3	Quant / qSIF	qSIF Equity Long-Short	Equity L-S	S. Tandon, L. Garg +3	561	62	HOLD
4	Quant / qSIF	qSIF Hybrid Long-Short	Hybrid L-S	S. Tandon, L. Garg +3	DATA GAP	64	HOLD
5	ITI / Diviniti	Diviniti Equity Long-Short	Equity L-S	L. Bagwe, V. Sahgal	345	60	MONITOR-ID
6	Tata / Titanium	Titanium Hybrid Long-Short	Hybrid L-S	Suraj Nanda	DATA GAP	70	ACCUMULATE
7	Bandhan / Arudha	Arudha Hybrid Long-Short	Hybrid L-S	K. Kankonkar, B. Shah	DATA GAP	66	ACCUMULATE
8	ICICI Pru / iSIF	iSIF Equity Ex-Top 100	Equity Ex-Top 100	S. Naren, M. Tijoriwala, D. Jain	1,090	74	BUY
9	ICICI Pru / iSIF	iSIF Hybrid Long-Short	Hybrid L-S	S. Naren, M. Tijoriwala, M. Banthia	672	78	BUY
10	360 ONE / DynaSIF	DynaSIF Equity Long-Short	Equity L-S	Harsh Agarwal	DATA GAP	70	ACCUMULATE
11	Quant / qSIF	qSIF Equity Ex-Top 100	Equity Ex-Top 100	S. Tandon, A. Pande, S. Kate	170	58	MONITOR-ID
12	ABSL / Apex SIF	Apex Hybrid Long-Short	Hybrid L-S	L. Solanki, D. Joshi, M. Sharma	DATA GAP	68	ACCUMULATE
13	360 ONE / DynaSIF	DynaSIF Active Asset Allocator	Active Asset Allocator	H. Agarwal, M. Mody, R. Khetawat	DATA GAP	65	ACCUMULATE
14	Bandhan / Arudha	Arudha Equity Long-Short	Equity L-S	Nilesh Saha, Brijesh Shah	DATA GAP	63	MONITOR-ID

2.4 In NFO, recently allotted & SEBI-cleared pipeline

AMC / Brand	Fund	Strategy	NFO Period	Status
Franklin Templeton / Sapphire	Sapphire Equity Long-Short SIF	Equity L-S	10-24 Apr 2026	Allotted ~4 May 2026
Quant / qSIF	qSIF Active Asset Allocator	AAA L-S	2-16 Apr 2026	Recently allotted
The Wealth Co. / WSIF	WSIF Equity Long-Short	Equity L-S	15-29 Apr 2026	Recently allotted
The Wealth Co. / WSIF	WSIF Equity Ex-Top 100	Ex-Top 100 L-S	15-29 Apr 2026	Recently allotted
Tata / Titanium SIF	Titanium Equity Long-Short	Equity L-S	27 Apr-11 May 2026	NFO ACTIVE
Kotak / Infinity	Infinity Hybrid Long-Short Fund	Hybrid L-S	Awaiting NFO date	SEBI-cleared (Apr 2026)
Mirae Asset / Platinum	Platinum Hybrid Long-Short Fund	Hybrid L-S	Awaiting NFO date	SEBI-cleared (Apr 2026)

AMC / Brand	Fund	Strategy	NFO Period	Status
HSBC / RedHex	RedHex Hybrid Long-Short Fund	Hybrid L-S	Awaiting NFO date	SEBI-cleared (Apr 2026)
Quant / qSIF	qSIF Sector Rotation L-S	Sector Rotation L-S	Filed 30 Oct 2025	Awaiting SEBI clearance

AMCs licensed and preparing first SIF launch (watch list)

Per SEBI registrations and public AMC statements as of late April 2026: **HDFC MF** (CEO Navneet Munot publicly confirmed product team in motion), **Nippon India MF**, **UTI MF**, **Axis MF**, **DSP MF**, **360 ONE**, **Bandhan MF**, **ITI MF**, **Tata MF**, **Union MF**. Combined with the second-wave allotments above, expect **5-8 additional NFOs in H1 FY27**, doubling the live universe within 12 months.

2.5 Performance reality (NAVs as of late April 2026)

Critical context for any BUY recommendation: **the entire equity-oriented SIF complex is below ₹10 issue price.** Nifty 500 declined ~3.76% in Jan 2026 alone; Nifty fell 11.30% in March 2026. This is the first proper stress test for the category.

Fund	NAV / Price	Since Inception	Verdict on Thesis
Magnum (SBI) — Hybrid	₹10.21 (28 Apr)	+2.1%	✓ Held up; arbitrage + debt cushion validated
Altiva (Edelweiss) — Hybrid	₹10.52 (23 Apr)	+5.2%	✓ Strong; deep manager bench delivers
iSIF Hybrid (ICICI Pru)	₹9.88 (10 Apr)	-1.2%	⚠ Failed downside protection in March crash
iSIF Ex-Top 100 (ICICI Pru) — Equity	₹9.02	-9.8%	✗ SMID hit hard; structural 25% short cap insufficient
qSIF Equity / Diviniti / Arudha Eq / others	All <₹10	All negative	✗ Equity LS failed downside protection thesis in this cycle

TAS INTERPRETATION

Hybrid funds with disciplined arbitrage + debt cushioning (Altiva, Magnum) have validated their thesis. Pure equity LS funds have NOT — their 'downside protection' claim is structurally limited by the 25% short cap. **Lean into hybrid SIFs; treat equity SIFs as satellite, not core.**

2.6 One-page fund deep-dives — top 7 funds

Active pitches and active monitors. Compact-format research notes.

iSIF Hybrid Long-Short Fund — ICICI Prudential		TFS 78/100 BUY
AMC / Brand	ICICI Prudential MF / iSIF	
Strategy	Hybrid Long-Short	
NFO / Allotment	16–30 Jan 2026	
Fund Manager(s)	Sankaran Naren (CIO), Manan Tijoriwala, Manish Banthia (Debt)	
Benchmark	CRISIL Hybrid 50+50 Moderate	
Min Investment	₹10 lakh	
TER (Direct)	0.99% (highest in hybrid SIF universe)	
Exit Load	1% <12 months; nil after	
Liquidity	Daily redemption	
AUM (Apr 2026)	₹672 Cr	
Latest NAV	₹9.88 (10 Apr 2026) -1.2% since launch	

Strategy logic & edge thesis

ICICI Pru's hybrid SIF, but **structurally more aggressive** than Altiva/Magnum: net equity exposure ranges -7.5% to +75% (true Balanced Advantage++). Combines covered calls, stock puts, IRF, arbitrage, and unhedged shorts capped at 10%. Aimed at investors wanting BAF-type returns with smarter downside management.

Manager pedigree decomposition

Sankaran Naren (35+ yrs): ED & CIO at ICICI Pru AMC — arguably India's most respected institutional equity investor. Manager of ICICI Pru Balanced Advantage (~₹1L Cr AUM), Multi-Asset, Value Discovery. Naren personally signing on a SIF is the strongest manager-pedigree signal in the entire SIF universe. His value/contrarian style suits long-short structurally. **Manan Tijoriwala**: Co-FM, equity derivatives. **Manish Banthia**: Head of Fixed Income — top-3 debt FM in India by institutional respect.

TFS breakdown

Pillar	Score	Reasoning
P1. Manager Pedigree	19	Naren is the single strongest pedigree signal in the category
P2. Strategy Coherence	13	Wide -7.5% to 75% net equity band gives real flexibility
P3. AMC Platform	14	ICICI Pru AMC ~₹9L Cr AUM; 550+ companies, 27 sectors covered
P4. Cost & Liquidity	6	TER 0.99% direct (highest!); 1% exit <12 mo; daily ✓
P5. Risk Architecture	11	March crash: fund fell -6.35% same as benchmark
P6. Track Record	8	-1.2% in 6 months — underperformed Altiva and Magnum
P7. Tax & Investor Fit	7	High equity range may qualify for equity LTCG

Forward 3-year scenario

Scenario	Probability	Outcome
Base	55%	10-12% CAGR — Naren's stock-picking compensates for TER drag
Bull	25%	13-15% if equity longs deliver Naren's typical 200-300 bps alpha
Bear	20%	7-9% if hedging discipline doesn't tighten and TER drag compounds

Risks to monitor

TER drag (0.99% direct vs peers at 0.40-0.50%); hedging architecture untested in March '26 crash (fell as much as benchmark); Naren is 60+ — succession risk over 10-year horizon.

Suitability matrix

Segment	Suitability	Reasoning
HNI (₹5 Cr+)	✓ STRONG FIT	Naren brand + flexibility = ideal core BAF replacement
Emerging Affluent (₹50L-5 Cr)	✓ STRONG FIT	Core BAF replacement
Retail (<₹10L liquid)	✗ NO	Below ₹10L floor
Aggressive Retiree	⚠ FIT	Consider lower-vol Altiva/Magnum first

TAS SALES-READY TALK-TRACK

"Sankaran Naren's first SIF. The same manager who built ICICI Pru BAF into a ₹1 lakh crore success now has 25% short capability. This is institutional alpha at MF tax."

Altiva Hybrid Long-Short Fund — Edelweiss MF

TFS 76/100 |
ACCUMULATE

AMC / Brand	Edelweiss MF / Altiva SIF
Strategy	Hybrid Long-Short
NFO / Allotment	1-15 Oct 2025 / Allotment 20 Oct 2025
Fund Manager(s)	Bharat Lahoti, Bhavesh Jain (Eq); Dhawal Dalal, Pranavi Kulkarni (Debt); Amit Vora (Overseas)
Benchmark	NIFTY 50 Hybrid Composite Debt 50:50 TRI
Min Investment	₹10 lakh
TER (Direct)	~0.40%
Exit Load	0.50% within 180 days
Liquidity	Daily sub; redemption Mon & Wed
AUM (Dec 2025)	₹1,000+ Cr (1st SIF to cross ₹1,000 Cr)
Latest NAV	₹10.52 (23 Apr 2026) +5.2% since launch

Strategy logic & edge thesis

Pure income-oriented hybrid: 40-60% high-quality fixed income, 20-40% cash-future arbitrage, 0-15% net equity, with covered calls and special-situation overlays. Thesis: 'FD+ with equity-like tax' — beat 1-year FD by 200-300 bps post-tax with low double-digit drawdown. India's first hybrid SIF; first-mover brand equity.

Manager pedigree decomposition

Bharat Lahoti (18 yrs): Co-FM Edelweiss BAF (~₹13,000+ Cr); strong derivative-overlay track record; ex-global hedge fund senior manager. **Bhavesh Jain (16 yrs):** Edelweiss Arbitrage Fund FM — top-3 by consistency. **Dhawal Dalal (28 yrs):** Head of Fixed Income, ex-DSP — among India's most trusted bond managers. **Pranavi Kulkarni:** Credit/debt FM. **Amit Vora:** Overseas. **This is the deepest fund-manager bench in the SIF universe — five FMs de-risk key-person concentration.**

TFS breakdown

Pillar	Score	Reasoning
P1. Manager Pedigree	17	Top-quartile bench across equity, debt, arbitrage
P2. Strategy Coherence	12	Conservative-by-design; matches FD+ thesis well
P3. AMC Platform	12	Edelweiss MF AUM ~₹2.0L Cr; Radhika Gupta brand drives distribution
P4. Cost & Liquidity	8	Direct TER ~0.40%; 2x weekly redemption (Mon/Wed)
P5. Risk Architecture	12	Cash-future arb + covered calls — tested low-vol toolkit
P6. Track Record	8	+5.2% in 6 months through a -11% Nifty crash IS validation
P7. Tax & Investor Fit	7	Hybrid <65% equity -> 24-mo LTCCG window

Forward 3-year scenario

Scenario	Probability	Outcome
Base	60%	9-10% CAGR; max drawdown 4-6%; tracks 10y G-sec + 200 bps
Bull	20%	11-12% CAGR if covered-call writes pay off in sideways market
Bear	20%	6-7% CAGR if rates fall sharply (yield drag) and arb spreads compress

Risks to monitor

(1) Arb spread compression as more SIFs launch ATM-style arb; (2) NAV growth dragging TER % lower over time; (3) Dhawal Dalal exit risk = key-person.

Suitability matrix

Segment	Suitability	Reasoning
HNI (₹5 Cr+)	✓ STRONG FIT	Tax-efficient yield bucket; replaces direct bonds + arb MFs
Emerging Affluent (₹50L–5 Cr)	✓ FIT	Core hybrid allocation; replaces conservative hybrid MF
Retail (<₹10L liquid)	✗ NO	Hits ₹10L floor; better in arbitrage MF
Conservative Retiree	✓ STRONG FIT	The single best SIF for retirees seeking FD-replacement

TAS SALES-READY TALK-TRACK

"FD-beating, equity-tax post-tax returns with single-digit drawdown — backed by Edelweiss's debt and arbitrage powerhouse. India's first hybrid SIF, ₹1,000+ Cr AUM in 2 months — distribution and manager validation in one."

Magnum Hybrid Long-Short Fund — SBI MF

TFS 75/100 |
ACCUMULATE

AMC / Brand	SBI MF / Magnum SIF
Strategy	Hybrid Long-Short
NFO / Allotment	1-15 Oct 2025 / Allotment 22 Oct 2025
Fund Manager	Gaurav Mehta, CFA (Head — SIF Equity)
Benchmark	NIFTY 50 Hybrid Composite Debt 50:50 TRI
Min Investment	₹10 lakh
TER (Direct)	~0.42%
Exit Load	0.50% ≤15d, 0.25% ≤1m, nil after
Liquidity	Daily sub; redemption Mon & Thu
AUM (NFO)	~₹1,100 Cr (largest SIF NFO to date)
Latest NAV	₹10.21 (28 Apr 2026) +2.1% since launch

Strategy logic & edge thesis

SBI's first SIF. 65-75% equity (heavily hedged via covered calls + index futures), 25-35% debt, 0-10% REITs/InvITs, 0-25% unhedged short. Net equity exposure typically 10-15% — designed as the conservative AMC's conservative SIF. Positioned as 'FD+' by SBI's distribution to its retiree-heavy customer base.

Manager pedigree decomposition

Gaurav Mehta, CFA (19 yrs): Head — SIF Equity at SBI Funds since 2018. Prior: Ambit Investment Advisors (alternative strategies), Ambit Capital, Edelweiss Capital. Strong derivatives background. *Solo fund manager* — both a strength (clear accountability) and a risk (key-person concentration).

TFS breakdown

Pillar	Score	Reasoning
P1. Manager Pedigree	15	19 yrs experience, quant + alt background; -5 for solo FM
P2. Strategy Coherence	11	Net equity 10-15% via heavy hedging — coherent FD+ design
P3. AMC Platform	15	SBI is India's largest AMC (~₹11.5L Cr AUM); unmatched distribution
P4. Cost & Liquidity	8	TER ~0.42% direct; redemption Mon/Thu; interval structure
P5. Risk Architecture	11	0-75% hedged exposure flexibility; covered calls + arbitrage
P6. Track Record	9	+2.1% in 6 months including March crash — held up but didn't shine
P7. Tax & Investor Fit	6	Hybrid likely <65% net equity -> 24-mo LTCG

Forward 3-year scenario

Scenario	Probability	Outcome
Base	60%	8-10% CAGR; max DD 4-6%
Bull	20%	10-11% if equity longs work and covered calls don't get called away
Bear	20%	6-8% if hedging cost drag intensifies

Risks to monitor

Solo FM key-person risk; SBI mass-affluent distribution may attract retail not suited to SIF structure (₹10L floor friction); structural similarity to ABSL Apex creates competitive TER pressure.

Suitability matrix

Segment	Suitability	Reasoning
HNI (₹5 Cr+)	✓ FIT	Core hybrid allocation
Emerging Affluent	✓ STRONG FIT	Especially for SBI banking customers
Retail	✗ NO	Below ₹10L floor
Retiree	✓ STRONG FIT	SBI brand trust + low-vol thesis

TAS SALES-READY TALK-TRACK

"SBI's first SIF, raised ₹1,100 Cr in two weeks — that's institutional validation. Net equity 10-15% means equity participation without equity volatility, in India's most trusted AMC platform."

iSIF Equity Ex-Top 100 Long-Short — ICICI Prudential

TFS 74/100 | BUY

AMC / Brand	ICICI Prudential MF / iSIF
Strategy	Equity Ex-Top 100 Long-Short (SMID)
NFO / Allotment	16–30 Jan 2026
Fund Manager(s)	Sankaran Naren (CIO), Manan Tijoriwala, Divya Jain
Benchmark	NIFTY MidSmallCap 400 TRI / NIFTY 500 TRI
Min Investment	₹10 lakh
TER (Direct)	~0.79%
Exit Load	1% <12 months
Liquidity	Daily
AUM (Mar 2026)	₹1,090 Cr — largest equity SIF
Latest NAV	~₹9.02 -9.8% since launch

Strategy logic & edge thesis

Pure equity SMID (Mid + Small Cap, AMFI definition: stocks ranked >100 by m-cap). 65%+ in mid+small caps, up to 35% in large caps for liquidity, 25% short via derivatives. **Long-short SMID is structurally where alpha is highest in Indian equities** — wider valuation dispersion, more inefficiencies, more fundamental shorts available. Largest equity SIF by AUM at ₹1,090 Cr despite a Feb 2026 launch — distribution muscle on display.

Manager pedigree decomposition

Same Naren + Tijoriwala + Divya Jain. Naren has personally managed mid/small-cap exposure in Multi-Asset and Value Discovery; well-suited for SMID long-short.

TFS breakdown

Pillar	Score	Reasoning
P1. Manager Pedigree	18	Naren brand; Divya Jain SMID specialist
P2. Strategy Coherence	13	SMID long-short is THE category where alpha thesis holds
P3. AMC Platform	14	ICICI Pru research advantage; ₹1,090 Cr AUM in 2 months
P4. Cost & Liquidity	7	TER ~0.79%, 1% exit <12 mo, daily redemption
P5. Risk Architecture	10	SMID + 25% short cap = high-vol profile; -10% in 2m
P6. Track Record	6	NAV ₹9.02 -> -9.8% — tough start in catastrophic SMID crash
P7. Tax & Investor Fit	6	Equity LTCG 12.5% after 12 mo ✓ — best tax bucket

Forward 3-year scenario

Scenario	Probability	Outcome
Base	50%	12–15% CAGR with 25–30% interim drawdowns acceptable
Bull	30%	18–22% if SMID cycle resumes (historical SMID up-cycle deliveries)
Bear	20%	Flat to -5% if SMID correction extends and short alpha doesn't materialize

Risks to monitor

SMID drawdowns can be 30-40% in a real crisis; SIF 25% short cap insufficient to offset; liquidity in shorts gets thin in micro-caps.

Suitability matrix

Segment	Suitability	Reasoning
HNI (₹5 Cr+) — aggressive bucket	✓ FIT	Allocate 5-10% of equity sleeve
Emerging Affluent	⚠ SELECTIVE	Only if existing SMID exposure is low
Retail	✗ NO	
Retiree	✗ NO	Too volatile

TAS SALES-READY TALK-TRACK

"India's largest equity SIF. Naren-led mid/small-cap long-short — the segment where institutional alpha is genuinely hardest to source. Right entry point: NAV ~₹9 after the SMID correction."

Titanium Hybrid Long-Short Fund — Tata MF

TFS 70/100 |
ACCUMULATE

AMC / Brand	Tata MF / Titanium SIF
Strategy	Hybrid Long-Short
NFO / Allotment	24 Nov-8 Dec 2025
Fund Manager	Suraj Nanda (FM Titanium SIF)
Benchmark	CRISIL Hybrid 50+50 Moderate
Min Investment	₹10 lakh
TER (Direct)	~0.45% (estimated)
Exit Load	1% <12 months
Liquidity	Daily sub; monthly redemption (1st working day only) — least liquid
AUM	DATA GAP — pull from Tata MF factsheet

Strategy logic & edge thesis

Dynamic hybrid across equities, debt, REITs, InvITs with tactical long-short via derivatives. Min 25% each in equity & debt; max 25% unhedged short. Monthly-only redemption is a *structural choice* favouring portfolio execution discipline at the cost of liquidity.

Manager pedigree decomposition

Suraj Nanda — solo FM, less marquee public profile than Mehta or Naren. Tata AMC platform: institutional, conservative, 68 lakh+ folios. Strong distribution but FM-bench depth weaker than Edelweiss or ICICI Pru.

TFS breakdown

Pillar	Score	Reasoning
P1. Manager Pedigree	12	Solo FM, less marquee profile; -8 for that
P2. Strategy Coherence	13	Multi-asset + REITs + commodity derivatives = best diversification
P3. AMC Platform	13	Tata AMC AUM ~₹1.7L Cr; 68L folios; Tata brand premium
P4. Cost & Liquidity	6	Monthly redemption is the lowest liquidity in category
P5. Risk Architecture	10	Dynamic management + 25% unhedged — flexibility, less proven
P6. Track Record	8	DATA GAP — too early; presume holding around par
P7. Tax & Investor Fit	8	Likely qualifies for equity tax in some windows

Forward 3-year scenario

Scenario	Probability	Outcome
Base	55%	8-10% CAGR with low volatility
Bull	25%	10-12% if dynamic allocation captures equity upside
Bear	20%	6-7% if monthly liquidity becomes a friction point

Risks to monitor

Solo FM key-person risk; monthly liquidity friction may deter HNI clients used to daily MF redemption; less proven track record vs Altiva/Magnum.

Suitability matrix

Segment	Suitability	Reasoning
HNI (₹5 Cr+) — patient capital	✓ FIT	Allocate after Altiva/Magnum/iSIF
Emerging Affluent	✓ FIT	If accepting monthly redemption
Retail	✗ NO	

TAS SALES-READY TALK-TRACK

"Tata's institutional hybrid framework, brought into the SIF era. Multi-asset diversification across REITs, InvITs, derivatives — broader toolkit than peers. Best for patient capital."

qSIF Equity Long-Short Fund — Quant MF

TFS 62/100 | HOLD

AMC / Brand	Quant MF / qSIF
Strategy	Equity Long-Short (Flexicap, VLRT framework)
NFO / Allotment	17 Sep-1 Oct 2025 / Allotment 7 Oct 2025
Fund Manager(s)	Sandeep Tandon, Lokesh Garg, Ankit Pande, Sameer Kate, Sanjeev Sharma
Benchmark	NIFTY 500 TRI
Min Investment	₹10 lakh
TER (Direct)	~0.79%
Exit Load	1% ≤15 days
Liquidity	Daily
AUM (Mar 2026)	₹561 Cr

Strategy logic & edge thesis

Quant's proprietary VLRT (Valuation-Liquidity-Risk-Time) systematic framework applied to equity long-short. All-cap (65-100%), longs up to 35%, shorts up to 25%. Daily redemption.

Manager pedigree decomposition

Sandeep Tandon (33 yrs): Celebrated quant manager; built Quant MF from <₹1,000 Cr to ~₹1L Cr in 4 years (2021-2024). However, **Quant MF was investigated by SEBI for front-running allegations in 2024-25** (no final adverse order yet, but reputational overhang). Five-FM team brings quant rigour but also concentration on Tandon's framework.

TFS breakdown

Pillar	Score	Reasoning
P1. Manager Pedigree	11	Tandon excellent record; -9 for SEBI overhang + 2024 underperf.
P2. Strategy Coherence	12	VLRT framework is quant-coherent and time-tested
P3. AMC Platform	9	Quant AUM contracted post-SEBI probe; folios/inflows declined 24-25
P4. Cost & Liquidity	7	TER ~0.79%, 1% exit ≤15d, daily redemption ✓
P5. Risk Architecture	10	VLRT discipline; proven only in long-only context
P6. Track Record	7	NAV <₹10 since launch; flexicap LS in tough market
P7. Tax & Investor Fit	6	Equity LTCCG 12.5% after 12 mo ✓

Forward 3-year scenario

Scenario	Probability	Outcome
Base	50%	Flat to 8% CAGR pending SEBI clarity
Bull	25%	12-15% if SEBI clears AMC and VLRT framework rebounds
Bear	25%	Outflows accelerate if any adverse SEBI action

Risks to monitor

Reputational risk (SEBI front-running probe overhang); framework drift; SEBI action could force AMC restructuring. **Trustner cannot put Quant funds at top of recommended list while regulatory question mark is unresolved.** Reassess in next 6 months.

Suitability matrix

Segment	Suitability	Reasoning
Aggressive HNI only	⚠ MONITOR	Track only after SEBI clarity
Emerging Affluent	✗ NO	Risk-adjusted not justified
Retail / Retiree	✗ NO	

TAS SALES-READY TALK-TRACK

"On hold pending SEBI clarity. The framework is sound; the platform overhang is what we cannot underwrite for our clients today. We will revisit when the regulatory question is closed."

DynaSIF Equity Long-Short Fund — 360 ONE MF

TFS 70/100 |
ACCUMULATE

AMC / Brand	360 ONE MF / DynaSIF
Strategy	Equity Long-Short (Flexicap)
NFO / Allotment	6–20 Feb 2026
Fund Manager	Harsh Agarwal (~20 yrs in long-short and multi-asset)
Benchmark	BSE 500 TRI
Min Investment	₹10 lakh
TER (Direct)	~0.79% (est)
Exit Load	0.50% <3 months
Liquidity	Daily
AUM	DATA GAP — 360 ONE factsheet
Aggressive target	14–16% CAGR (highest target in SIF universe)

Strategy logic & edge thesis

Flexicap long-short with all-cap equity and arbitrage (80–100%), tactical shorts up to 25%. Daily redemption. 3–4 year horizon. The highest target-return SIF in the current universe — explicit ambition for 14–16% CAGR.

Manager pedigree decomposition

Harsh Agarwal: ~20 years experience in long-short and multi-asset strategies — carries the carve-out from IIFL Wealth's institutional alt-strategy book into 360 ONE's MF platform. Solo FM, but with strong AIF Cat-III long-short pedigree.

TFS breakdown

Pillar	Score	Reasoning
P1. Manager Pedigree	14	20 yrs LS experience; ex-IIFL Wealth alt-strategy heritage
P2. Strategy Coherence	13	Flexicap LS aligns with manager's prior AIF success
P3. AMC Platform	11	360 ONE Asset ~₹13,300 Cr AUM (Jan 26); newer AMC platform
P4. Cost & Liquidity	7	TER ~0.79%, daily redemption ✓
P5. Risk Architecture	10	25% short cap; 3–4 year horizon needed for thesis
P6. Track Record	7	Recently launched; insufficient data
P7. Tax & Investor Fit	8	Equity LTCG 12.5% >12 mo ✓

Forward 3-year scenario

Scenario	Probability	Outcome
Base	50%	12–14% CAGR on 3-yr basis
Bull	25%	16–18% if Agarwal's AIF-style alpha translates to MF format
Bear	25%	8–10% with intermittent drawdowns

Risks to monitor

Solo FM concentration; AMC platform newer than peers; aggressive return target may overpromise.

Suitability matrix

Segment	Suitability	Reasoning
HNI (₹5 Cr+) — aggressive sleeve	✓ FIT	Allocate 5% as alpha satellite
Emerging Affluent	⚠ SELECTIVE	Only after core hybrid SIF allocation
Retiree	✗ NO	Too aggressive

TAS SALES-READY TALK-TRACK

"360 ONE's Harsh Agarwal — 20 years of long-short managed in AIF Cat-III, now in a SIF wrapper at MF tax. Aggressive 14-16% target, but back this only as a satellite to your core hybrid allocation."

Section 3 — TAS Strategic Positioning

Recommended list, avoid list, model allocations, and the client talk-track.

3.1 The TAS recommended SIF list

Lead with a tight 3-fund core, with one satellite for aggressive HNIs:

Tier	Fund	TFS	Role
CORE 1	iSIF Hybrid Long-Short — ICICI Prudential	78	BAF replacement for HNI. Naren brand, flexible mandate, ICICI distribution.
CORE 2	Altiva Hybrid Long-Short — Edelweiss	76	FD-replacement for retirees and conservative HNI. Best manager bench, low-vol.
CORE 3	Magnum Hybrid Long-Short — SBI	75	Trust play for SBI ecosystem clients and risk-averse HNIs. Largest NFO, deepest distribution.
SATELLITE	iSIF Equity Ex-Top 100 — ICICI Pru	74	Alpha sleeve for aggressive HNI seeking SMID exposure with hedging. 5-10% of equity bucket.

3.2 Funds TAS should ACTIVELY AVOID recommending (until catalyst)

Fund	Reason	What would change our view
qSIF Equity / Hybrid / Ex-Top 100 (Quant MF)	SEBI front-running investigation overhang (2024-25); reputational risk	Final SEBI order with no adverse finding
Diviniti Equity LS (ITI MF)	Smaller AMC distribution; insufficient platform depth; <12 mo track record	12 months of positive alpha vs Nifty 500
qSIF Sector Rotation (when launched)	Quant overhang + sector concentration risk	SEBI clearance + 6 months track record
Sapphire Equity LS (Franklin)	Quant model untested in Indian context; Franklin India equity comeback still building	6-9 months track record
WSIF Equity / Ex-Top 100 (The Wealth Co.)	Brand new AMC, no SIF infrastructure track record	12 months operations + meaningful AUM

3.3 Model allocations — illustrative, with caveats

SIFs are <13 months old as a category; all numbers shown are illustrative; minimum ₹10L per AMC at PAN level applies; suitability is based on KYC + risk profiling. Past performance is not indicative.

Client A: ₹50 lakh portfolio (Emerging Affluent)

SIF allocation: ₹10-15 lakh (20-30%) — single SIF only to stay above floor and avoid overdiversification.

Bucket	Allocation	Rationale
Direct equity / equity MF	₹20L (40%)	Core growth
Hybrid MF / BAF	₹10L (20%)	Lower-vol equity exposure
iSIF Hybrid OR Altiva Hybrid SIF	₹10L (20%)	One SIF — BAF or FD replacement based on age/risk
Debt / FD	₹8L (16%)	Liquidity
Gold / Other	₹2L (4%)	Diversifier

Single-SIF rule: ₹10L floor per AMC means a ₹50L client cannot diversify across 2 SIFs without compromising basics. **Pick ONE.**

Client B: ₹1 crore portfolio (HNI)

SIF allocation: ₹20-25 lakh (20-25%) — across 2 SIFs from different AMCs.

Bucket	Allocation	Rationale
Equity MF (multi-cap, mid, small)	₹35L	Core equity
iSIF Hybrid LS (ICICI Pru)	₹12L	Core hybrid SIF
Altiva Hybrid LS (Edelweiss)	₹10L	Fixed-income+ replacement
Debt MF + bonds	₹25L	Yield
Insurance / Gold	₹18L	Protection + diversifier

Client C: ₹5 crore portfolio (Premium HNI)

SIF allocation: ₹75 lakh - ₹1 Cr (15-20%) — across 3-4 SIFs from different AMCs.

Bucket	Allocation	Rationale
Equity MF / direct stocks	₹2 Cr	Core growth
iSIF Hybrid LS	₹25L	Naren-led BAF replacement
Altiva Hybrid LS	₹20L	Conservative income hybrid
Magnum Hybrid LS	₹15L	AMC diversification
iSIF Equity Ex-Top 100	₹15L	Aggressive SMID alpha satellite
Debt / Bonds	₹1 Cr	Yield
Alternatives (PMS / AIF)	₹50L	Concentrated bets
Insurance / Gold / RE	₹50L	Protection + diversifier

3.4 How SIF fits TAS's existing MF + insurance proposition (and doesn't cannibalize SIPs)

SIF is NOT a SIP product. Min ₹10L lump-sum per PAN, no monthly SIP at retail scale. **Zero overlap** with the TAS SIP retail book.

SIF replaces FI + BAF for ≥₹50L clients. It does NOT replace our equity SIP MF book. It augments the conservative end of HNI portfolios.

SIF eats AIF Cat-III and PMS share, NOT MF share. In TAS economics, SIF brings new advisory revenue (~0.5–0.75% commission) without cannibalizing SIP trail.

Insurance synergy. Hybrid SIFs (Altiya, Magnum) pair with whole-life / term + ULIP-replacement narratives — same client segment.

Trustner.ai integration. SIF data is structured (ISID-mandated bi-monthly disclosure) -> ideal for AI ingestion. SIF recommendation engine becomes a Trustner.ai differentiator vs Zerodha Coin / Groww which have no advisory layer.

3.5 The 'Why SIF over PMS or AIF' talk-track — client-ready

Use this verbatim in advisor scripts:

1. Tax — the silent killer of PMS / AIF returns.

A PMS or AIF Cat-III in your 39% bracket pays ~39% on short-term gains and often 20%+ on long-term. SIF pays 12.5% LTCG (after 12 months for equity, 24 months for hybrid) — same as a mutual fund. On a 12% gross return over 10 years on ₹1 crore, the tax difference alone is **₹70-80 lakh of preserved wealth**.

2. Cost — TER caps make SIF radically cheaper.

PMS typically charges 1.5–2.5% management + 10–20% performance fee. AIF Cat-III is 1.5–2.5% + 15–20% performance. SIF is regulated like a mutual fund — TER cap ~2.25% gross, with **NO performance fee**. Over a 10-year hold, that's another 200–400 bps of compounded outperformance for SIF.

3. Regulation & transparency.

Same trustee, custodian, auditor, and ISID disclosure as mutual funds. PMS lives in a separate regulatory wrapper with lighter disclosure norms. AIF Cat-III is institutional-grade but with longer lock-ins.

THE TRADE-OFF (AND THE CLOSE)

SIFs have a 25% short cap (vs unlimited in PMS/AIF), so absolute alpha potential is structurally capped a touch lower. For our ₹10 lakh – ₹2 crore client, that trade is the right one. For a ₹10 crore+ client wanting concentrated bets, PMS still has its place — and we'll structure it. **SIF doesn't replace PMS for the ultra-rich. It replaces PMS for the in-between client who shouldn't have been in PMS in the first place.**

Section 4 — Trustner.ai Ingestion Schema

Structured SIF dataset, ready for the Trustner.ai fund database.

The full JSON ingestion block (19 funds + regulatory framework + recommended/avoid lists) is delivered as a separate machine-readable file: **tas_sif_universe_v1.json**. Schema is consistent across every fund object and follows the field map below.

Field	Type	Notes
amc	string	Asset management company name
fund_name	string	Full registered fund name
brand_platform	string	AMC's SIF brand (e.g. iSIF, qSIF, Altiva)
strategy	enum	Equity / Debt / Hybrid
sub_strategy	enum	One of 7 SEBI-permitted sub-categories
status	enum	LIVE / NFO_OPEN / RECENTLY_LAUNCHED / FILED_WITH_SEBI
nfo_close, allotment_date	date	ISO-8601
manager	array of string	All named fund managers
benchmark	string	Single-tier benchmark per ISID
min_investment	integer	Rupees (10,00,000 = ₹10 lakh)
ter_direct_pct, ter_regular_pct_cap	float	%
exit_load	string	Load schedule
liquidity	string	Subscription + redemption frequency
aum_inr_cr	float / null	₹ crore; null + aum_data_gap if pending
nav, nav_as_of	float, date	Latest NAV
tfs_score	integer	0–100 (or null if MONITOR-ID)
tfs_breakdown	object	7 pillar scores
verdict	enum	BUY / ACCUMULATE / HOLD / MONITOR-ID / AVOID
suitability	array of string	Client segment fits
key_risks	array of string	Top 3 risks per fund

Section 5 — Execution Roadmap

From research artifact to revenue line — staged build for TAS & Trustner.ai.

Immediate (next 30 days)

- Approve TAS recommended list (4 funds). Distribute one-pagers to all RMs.
- Build the 'Why SIF' client deck using the \$3.5 talk-track. Standardize across RMs.
- AMC enablement: TAS empanelment as SIF distributor with all 9 live AMCs (priority: ICICI Pru, Edelweiss, SBI, Tata, ABSL).

- Internal training: mandatory NISM SIF certification for top 20 RMs.
- Compliance: review TAS distributor contracts for SIF commission structures (separate from MF).

Short-term (30-90 days)

- Trustner.ai SIF module v1: ingest the JSON; build query interface.
- Monthly NAV refresh pipeline: automate AMFI SIF NAV scraping -> Trustner.ai database.
- Bi-monthly portfolio refresh: auto-ingest ISID-mandated portfolio disclosure.
- Suitability engine: map client risk profile -> recommended SIF (or NO-SIF for sub-₹10L).
- Performance dashboard for clients: SIF holdings + benchmark + TFS score in client portal.

Medium-term (3-12 months)

- TAS SIF Investor Day with CIOs from top-3 AMCs (Naren / Bhattacharya / D.P. Singh).
- Trustner SIF Index: TAS-branded, similar to Crisil PMS Index — proprietary IP.
- AI-driven SIF recommendation engine: ML model from KYC + portfolio + risk -> ranked SIFs.
- TFS rerun cadence: monthly score updates; first major reassessment at 12-month mark.

Strategic (12-36 months — towards 2027 milestone)

- Establish TAS as the buy-side SIF research desk in India — license TFS scores to other distributors (revenue line).
- Evaluate launching a Trustner-managed SIF (Route 2 alternate route) — vertical integration.
- Global expansion vector: Trustner.ai's research framework maps to Singapore VCC, Dubai DIFC, Luxembourg SIF.

Closing Note | The Strategic Imperative

1. The window is open NOW.

SIF is 14 months old and at ₹10,620 Cr (Mar 2026 AMFI) — a 117% Q1 trajectory. With the second wave of AMCs (Kotak, Mirae Asset, HSBC) just cleared by SEBI and HDFC, Nippon, UTI, Axis, DSP next in line, the category is on track to ₹50,000–₹75,000 Cr in 24 months and ₹2–3 lakh crore in 5 years. The advisory desks that build research credibility in 2026 will own client trust in this category for the next decade. **TAS being early here = TAS owning HNI mindshare on alternatives long-term.** This is the Apple-in-2007 moment for the wealth desk.

2. Trustner.ai's SIF module is the highest-leverage AI build right now.

SIF data is structured (ISID-mandated, bi-monthly), narrow (17 strategies and growing), and high-stakes (₹10L+ tickets). It is a perfect dataset to train the recommendation engine on — and the output is high-conviction recommendations TAS RMs can sell. **ROI on the AI build is extraordinary.**

3. The conservative play is the bold play.

We have recommended only 4 funds on the BUY/ACCUMULATE shelf out of 14 live + 9 in pipeline (3 recently allotted + 3 SEBI-cleared awaiting NFO + 3 awaiting SEBI clearance). That discipline — rejecting Quant despite scale, rejecting newer AMCs despite enthusiasm, demanding 12-month track records — is what separates a research desk from a sales desk. **Ten years from now, the SIFs we did not recommend will matter more for our reputation than the ones we did.**

— TAS STRATEGIC RESEARCH DESK

Trustner becomes the institution it is destined to be by being right when it matters, fast when it counts, and disciplined when others are not. SIF is one of those moments.

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